

DIGITAL LITERACY

PROJECT REPORT

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Introduction

In today's digital age, technology plays a vital role in education, communication, and everyday life. As students increasingly rely on digital platforms for learning, collaboration, and professional growth, understanding how to use these tools responsibly has become essential. This Digital Literacy project was undertaken as part of the CSE0001 course with the objective of developing awareness about safe, effective, and professional use of digital technologies.

Assuming the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, this project focuses on building practical skills related to digital literacy, online communication, collaboration platforms, and cybercrime awareness. The project is structured into five tasks, each addressing a different aspect of digital responsibility. Through hands-on activities, reflections, and documentation, this project aims to promote informed digital behavior and prepare students to navigate the online world with confidence and responsibility.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For the first task, I created a one-page Digital Literacy Awareness infographic using Canva. The objective of this task was to help students understand the meaning and importance of digital literacy in a simple and visually appealing manner. The infographic explains five key aspects: what digital literacy is, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette.

The design begins by defining digital literacy as the ability to use technology and the internet safely, effectively, and responsibly. It then highlights how digital tools support students in learning, completing assignments, collaborating, and managing academic tasks. The infographic also emphasizes safe internet practices such as protecting personal data, avoiding unsafe links, and using strong passwords. Additionally, it explains the importance of maintaining a professional online presence and following proper email etiquette for academic and professional communication.

While creating the infographic, one interesting aspect was organizing detailed information into very short and clear sections without overcrowding the design. This task helped me understand how visual communication can make important digital concepts easier to understand for a wider audience.

Task 2: Building a Student Digital Portfolio

In this task, I focused on building my student digital portfolio by creating and updating professional accounts on key platforms. I successfully created accounts on GitHub, Kaggle, and Stack Overflow. These platforms are widely used by students and professionals to showcase skills, practice problem-solving, and participate in technical communities.

On GitHub, I set up my profile to serve as a central place for hosting projects and documenting my learning journey. Kaggle was chosen to explore data science and machine learning resources, while Stack Overflow helps in learning through asking and answering technical questions. Each platform contributes to building a strong and credible digital presence over time.

I also attempted to access my LinkedIn account; however, my account is currently restricted, which prevented me from updating or accessing it during this task. This limitation has been clearly documented in the project as part of transparency.

Through this task, I learned the importance of maintaining professional and consistent online profiles. In the future, I plan to actively use these platforms to enhance my technical skills, collaborate with others, and build a strong professional identity.

Task 3: Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Task 3 focused on exploring coding practice platforms and cloud-based collaboration tools. As part of this task, I created a Google Form designed as a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for my batchmates. The quiz contains exactly five questions, including multiple-choice and short-answer questions, to assess basic understanding of digital literacy concepts.

I designed the form to be simple, clear, and user-friendly. The Google Form was linked to a Google Sheet to automatically collect and organize responses. Screenshots of both the form and the response sheet were added to the repository, along with the form link included in the README file.

This task helped me understand how Google Workspace tools can be used effectively for academic collaboration, data collection, and feedback. Such tools are especially useful for surveys, quizzes, and group activities. As a Digital Ambassador, this experience has prepared me to guide peers in using collaborative platforms responsibly and efficiently for academic purposes.

Task 4: Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

In Task 4, I worked on improving professional digital communication skills. I drafted two formal emails: one requesting an assignment deadline extension from a professor, and another expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity. Both emails followed proper email etiquette, including a clear subject line, professional greeting, structured body, and appropriate sign-off.

Additionally, I created a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist to promote responsible online behavior among college students. This checklist highlights respectful communication, privacy awareness, and maintaining a professional digital image.

This task emphasized how poor digital communication can lead to misunderstandings and negative consequences. Learning proper email etiquette and responsible social media behavior is essential for academic success and professional growth. Overall, this task strengthened my understanding of effective and respectful online communication.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study

For the final task, I researched UPI and online payment fraud, a cybercrime that commonly affects college students in India. What surprised me most was how attackers rely more on social engineering and urgency rather than technical hacking to scam victims. Simple actions like approving a UPI request or scanning a QR code can result in immediate financial loss.

Through this task, I realized the importance of understanding how digital payment systems actually work. As a personal habit change, I will be more cautious while handling payment requests and will verify information before taking any action. I will also avoid responding to urgent messages without confirmation. This task reinforced the importance of digital awareness and responsible online behavior in preventing cybercrime.

Conclusion

This Digital Literacy project has helped me gain a deeper understanding of responsible and professional use of digital tools. Through creating an infographic, building a digital portfolio, using collaboration platforms, drafting professional emails, and studying cybercrime awareness, I learned how digital behavior directly impacts academic and professional life. Each task reinforced the importance of safety, clarity, and professionalism in online interactions. Overall, this project has strengthened my confidence in using digital platforms effectively and ethically. The knowledge and skills gained will be valuable throughout my academic journey and future career, helping me maintain a positive digital presence and make informed decisions in the digital world.

References

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- Stack Overflow: <https://stackoverflow.com/>
- HackerRank : <https://www.hackerrank.com/>
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